



MN Greenstep Schools

Increasing Brand Presence & Youth
Engagement



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MN Greenstep Initial Case

Overview

MN Greenstep is a voluntary sustainability assistance and recognition program for cities, schools, and communities. It offers a pathway to take part in climate change action.

Purpose

Our goal is to help expand awareness, grow student engagement, and strengthen Greenstep's presence across Minnesota schools.



Project Objectives

- How to grow student engagement?
- How to support clubs consistently?
- How to increase brand visibility?
- How to motivate club participation?



The Case for GreenStep Clubs

- Students care about sustainability
- No clear way to get involved
- Clubs offer a scalable entry point
- Aligns youth action with state goals
- Builds visibility and future leadership
- Low cost, high long-term impact



Our Recommended Models

New Clubs

- Start fresh under GreenStep name
- Direct branding, full toolkit support

Rebranding

- Club shifts it's full identity to GreenStep
- Less recommended due to pushback

Hybrid

- Uses existing clubs as partners
- Add GreenStep themes, projects



What's in it for Students?

- Real-world leadership and project skills
- State-level recognition of club efforts
- Networking with sustainability peers
- Social media boosts and awards
- Add to college and job applications
- Flexible joining process for any club



Common App Examples

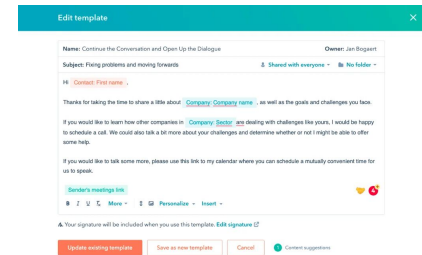


- "Led a state-recognized GreenStep Club, partnering with MN agencies to drive sustainability projects and present at the GreenStep Leadership Summit."
- "Partnered with MN GreenStep to promote energy efficiency at my school, leading efforts to reduce waste and improve sustainability."
- "Led a GreenStep awareness campaign, using social media and outreach to educate peers on sustainability initiatives."
- "Developed a waste reduction project through MN GreenStep, encouraging composting and recycling programs at my school."
- "Collaborated with other MN GreenStep Clubs to share best practices and strengthen student-led environmental initiatives statewide."



Club Support System & Toolkit

- Startup guide with step-by-step help
- Templates: agendas, flyers, emails, decks
- Event and project idea bank
- Branding kits for club visibility
- Guides for faculty and administration
- Ongoing support through regular check-ins



Running a GreenStep Club

- Meet 1–2 times per month
- Start with issue-based learning
- Follow with project planning
- Toolkit supports every activity
- Flexible for formal/informal clubs
- Leadership rotates with transition tools



Biggest Challenges

#1

Limited Visibility

Many students, faculty, and administrators remain unaware of the program.

#2

Perceived Barriers to Entry

Misconceptions around eligibility, paperwork, or expectations may deter students.

#3

Unclear Incentives for Participation

Less clear benefits, such as our proposed peer network need to be highlighted.



Student Visibility & Brand Building

- Students run social media pages
- Branded templates guide local content
- Peer-led presentations drive recruitment
- Press kits for news and websites
- Club-led campaigns build school pride
- Summit and event coverage adds value



Peer Outreach & Club Networking

- Club collaboration through shared challenges
- Monthly virtual spotlights and showcases
- Statewide Slack or Reddit network
- Regional or online summits for leads
- Recognition events build momentum
- Peer mentoring between new and old clubs



Marketing Plan

- Personalize approach for each school
- Collaborate with faculty and staff
- Tie into local needs and partners
- Support clubs with easy resources
- Co-create goals with each school



Immediate Next Steps

- Build and pilot club toolkit
- Highlight early clubs online
- Use students and volunteers to help
- Test, revise, and scale gradually
- Treat early phase as proof-of-concept



Future of MN GreenStep Clubs

- More schools launch GreenStep Clubs
- Student network becomes fully active
- Schools collaborate across local areas
- GreenStep recognized widely in schools
- Long-term relationships created for students





A Strategic Framework for Expanding GreenStep Clubs in Minnesota Schools

Confidential Proposal for the Minnesota GreenStep Team
and Program Stakeholders

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Questions?

